

Make an Open Source Drone, Pre-flight check

Before every flight, please follow the process outlined in this document to ensure that your drone is safe to fly:

1. Take your quadcopter, your props, +1 pair of spare props (in case one breaks), your laptop (at least for the first flight), a cable for connecting laptop and drone, a pair of glasses (sunglasses, or protection glasses) and the hex-key to tighten the propellers.
2. Go to a large open space environment, with no other people within 30m of your position you and 50m away from property. Ensure that you are familiar and comply with local rules for operating recreational small unmanned aircraft.
3. Safety first. Attach the propellers to the drone and tighten them using the hex-key screwdriver. Ensure they will not become detached during the flight.
4. Connect your drone to your laptop, open Mission Planner and check to see how many satellites it has found so far. When you the GPS has a lock on 8 or more satellites, you may unplug the drone from your PC. This step is necessary for the first few flights at least, in order to confirm that the location you have chosen has good GPS signal coverage.
5. Make sure that you have calibrated everything correctly on the Mission Planner and pre-arm check is ON.
6. Connect your battery alarm buzzer to your drone, if you have one.
7. Be sure you have all transmitter sticks to their initial positions before you turn it ON. Throttle stick should be down, pitch-roll still centred and all other switches UP.
8. Connect the battery, take care to connect the battery cables underneath the arm, so that they do not get in the way of the propeller.
9. Arm the drone.
10. Give some throttle and confirm that the drone responds appropriately.
11. You are ready to fly.

